

2c. Content of Applied psychology (Component 03)

This component consists of **one** compulsory section:

- Issues in mental health.

Learners will also choose to study **two** out of the following applied psychology options:

- Child psychology
- Criminal psychology
- Environmental psychology
- Sports and exercise psychology.

Each topic contains the following:

Background

With reference to psychology, learners should be able to explain and exemplify the background and consider relevant issues and debates in relation to the topic area.

Key research

Learners should be able to describe the key research and appreciate how it relates to the topic area.

Application

Learners should be able to relate the application to a novel situation.

There are a number of methodological issues and debates that run throughout Applied psychology (Component 03).

The assessment will require learners to apply these issues and debates across a range of topics, further developing the material in the specification and making links between the issues and debates and the content of this component.

Methodological issues and debates	Content
• Nature/nurture • Freewill/determinism • Reductionism/holism • Individual/situational explanations • Usefulness of research • Ethical considerations • Conducting socially sensitive research • Psychology as a science • Ethnocentrism • Validity • Reliability • Sampling bias.	• Description of concepts, theories and studies specified by the indicative content. • Application of methodological issues and debates in psychology. • Recognition of the contribution the key research has made to the topic. • Application of the background, key research and application to novel situations with which psychologists might be concerned. • Consideration of ways in which different areas of psychology can inform our understanding of applied psychology. • Exploration of social, moral, cultural and spiritual issues where applicable. • Recognition of how the key research contributes to an understanding of individual, social and cultural diversity. • Recognition of how society makes decisions about scientific issues and how psychology contributes to the success of the economy and society.

Section A: Issues in mental health (compulsory)

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Topic	Background	Key research	Application
The historical context of mental health	• Historical views of mental illness • Defining abnormality • Categorising mental disorders	Rosenhan (1973) On being sane in insane places.	Characteristics of an affective disorder, a psychotic disorder and an anxiety disorder.
The medical model	• The biochemical explanation of mental illness • The genetic explanation of mental illness • Brain abnormality as an explanation of mental illness	Gottesman et al. (2010) Disorders in offspring with two psychiatrically ill parents.	Biological treatment of one specific disorder.
Alternatives to the medical model	• The behaviourist explanation of mental illness • The cognitive explanation of mental illness One from: • the humanistic explanation of mental illness • the psychodynamic explanation of mental illness • the cognitive neuroscience explanation of mental illness.	Szasz (2011) The myth of mental illness: 50 years later.	Non-biological treatment of one specific disorder.

For full references please see Appendix 5f.